CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 20: **Fire and Ice (First Flight Poem)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The poem's grim theme and light diction produce: 1

(a) comic relief **(b)** pathos **(c)** irony of tone **(d)** epic grandeur

2. Frost's poem relies on which poetic device? 1

(a) dramatic monologue **(b)** epic simile
(c) extended metaphor **(d)** ode

3. Choose the correct conditional: 'If the world ___ twice, ice would suffice.' 1

(a) had to perish **(b)** perishes **(c)** perished not **(d)** has perished

4. What does the poem imply about the relationship between the individual and the world? 1

(a) nothing matters **(b)** the world is independent
(c) personal feelings can shape global fate **(d)** poems cannot affect

5. The poem's argument is built on: 1

(a) a hypothesis and personal evidence **(b)** a letter
(c) a story **(d)** a debate

6. The poem's brevity is an example of: 1

(a) repetition **(b)** economy of expression
(c) exaggeration **(d)** digression

7. In 'Those who favour fire', 'who favour fire' is: 1

(a) a relative clause **(b)** a noun clause
(c) a phrase **(d)** a main clause

8. The phrase 'to perish twice' implies: 1

(a) a real second event **(b)** a poem in two parts
(c) a lost poem **(d)** a hypothetical second destruction

9. A feature of free-flowing yet rhymed lines is: 1

(a) song **(b)** conversational rhythm
(c) military precision **(d)** chant

10. A synonym of 'craving' is: 1

(a) slight wish **(b)** fear **(c)** doubt **(d)** intense desire

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How does the poem convert a cosmic question into a moral one? 2

12. What does 'suffice' tell us about the speaker's view of hatred? 2

13. How does the rhyme scheme reinforce meaning? 2

14. Why is the placing of the personal 'I' significant? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Critically assess the claim that the poem is 'a warning in disguise'. 3

16. Does the poem offer hope? Argue your view. 3

17. Convert to direct speech: He said that ice would also suffice. 3

OR

Discuss the effect of syntax in the line 'From what I've tasted of desire'. 3

18. Discuss how the poem treats the theme of human responsibility. 3

OR

Use 'neither...nor' and 'either...or' in sentences on the poem. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. 'Fire and Ice' is a poem of few words and large implications. Discuss. 5

OR

Write an analytical note on the poet's use of the first person and conversational style. 5

20. Critically examine the use of symbolism, irony and tone in the poem. 5

OR

Imagine the poem as a speech by a world leader. Write the first paragraph. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND